

Building the product on their own, they no longer need to be dependent on a third-party vendor. They'll have the freedom of selecting any technology they wish to incorporate which will be easily integrated into their existing infrastructure. The control of the product roadmap will be in the hand of the organisation itself. They will always have the freedom to decide when and what features need to be added to the product. Finally, the end product will be unique where none of the competitors will have a similar application.

Buy

The most important advantage of off-the-shelf products is that they are finished products. Whenever an organisation needs it, they can get it. In a more real scenario, there could be an urgent requirement in case they can't afford the time to build the application. Getting these off-the-shelf products becomes an ideal solution at such times. Flexibility and adaptability of these products are generally higher in comparison with custom solutions as these products must compete in the market. Number of bugs is minimal as these products have already been used and tested by various other organisations. Another advantage is these off-the-shelf products are associated with a one-time cost. Sometimes they turn out to be much lower than custom built products on long term. The product vendor provides training and expert support, reducing any kind of burden from the organisation. The product vendors are solely responsible for continuous functional enhancement of the product and the organisation doesn't need to supply its resources for this.

Disadvantages

Build

Building an in-house software is a lengthy process. The organisation has to invest a lot of resources in terms of developer, hardware, and tools. Time is required for conducting requirement analysis before the actual development can be started. If there is an urgent requirement then an in-house solution isn't a solution. Some training has to be conducted by the organisation itself and eventually engage developers for providing full-time support. Hence, this could result into a resource crunch. It is challenging to stay updated when business demands rapid changes. Finally, the biggest disadvantage is that development of custom software is a trial and error method. Stability of these kind of products is lower than off-the-shelf products. Development of custom software is generally requirement driven. Hence, these products aren't much flexible.